

in the city

snippets

Reviving Rumi's magic

The Mahindra Excellence in Theatre Award, to be held in Delhi on March 6, will see Mohini Kent's production, *Rumi: Unveil the Sun*, being nominated in 12 categories. This includes 'best play', 'best director', 'best stage design' and 'best choreography'. Written by the mother-daughter duo of Amrit and Mohini Kent and directed by

Rumi's life.

Says Mohini, who has been reading Rumi's works for the past two decades: "I feel his poetry has an exalted spirituality, yet is not bereft of a human touch. There's a freshness

rated with her mother Amrit, an eminent Urdu scholar. Amrit has also worked on the play's music, along with music director Jatinder Singh. "The play includes poetry, music and dance and we've adapted

Rumi's Farsi ghazals into Urdu," says Mohini.

Rumi, which had three sold-out performances at Shaw Theatre in London last year, and ran to packed houses when it was

Sohaila Kapur, the play is based on the 13th century Persian poet and theologian Rumi and his encounter with the wandering mystic Shams, whose death eventually led Rumi to write astonishingly spiritual poetry. The play deals with a period of immense conflict and transformation in

about his works and they're as relevant, beautiful and powerful today as they were when he wrote it. Most importantly, his poetry throws light on the Islam face of love, which is completely neglected these days."

For this project, which involved months of research on Rumi and his life, Mohini collabo-

staged last December in Delhi, to coincide with the poet's death anniversary, has Oroon Das, a Delhi-based actor in the lead role as Rumi and Danish Husain as Shams. "*Rumi* has also been nominated for the Sahitya Kala Parishad award, to be announced in May," says Kent. Catch the action on March 1



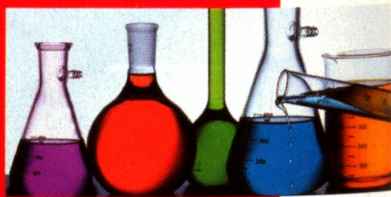
A still from Mohini and Amrit Kent's *Rumi: Unveil the Sun*

events



Gearing up

Delhi-based band Menwhopause, which recently won the best band award at the Jack Daniel's Mash Awards, is heading to Tennessee in April to perform at the Mash Awards at the international level. Last year the band had the honour of being the only Indian entrant to perform at the South By South West music festival in Texas.



Gender bender

Celebrating India's femme force this Women's Day, on March 8, will be the National Conference of Women Scientists. This three-day meet at Vigyan Bhavan will see participation from women scientists in government and private research institutions, academic institutes and R & D organisations.